



Warning: You must be fully prepared for an online ham radio test

- **Practice!** It is your responsibility to be fully prepared since you will be taking the time of volunteers and a time slot from other candidates. Be sure you are consistently scoring above 85% on practice tests.
- **Know the material!** You should be able to complete the exam within 15 minutes. Most questions are short and simple concepts. You either know them or you don't. We allocate 20 minutes per person from setup to finish.
- **Practice Sites:** We recommend either HamStudy.org, a free site with lots of tips, or ARRL Exam Review for Ham Radio™, a free site from the national ham radio group that you may want to join.
- **One Exam per Session:** Due to the difficulty of administering exams online one person at a time, you may normally take only ONE exam per session, unless you have prearranged for multiple exams with the exam team. You must have studied, practiced, and be scoring passing grades for the exams you want to take. Email us in advance.
- **Certificate of Successful Completion of Exam (CSCE):** The Exam Manager will send you a CSCE that includes your digital signature that you will keep for your records when you pass any element.

FCC Universal Licensing System (ULS)

- **Exam Application:** Within 48 hours after you make an appointment for an exam, the exam team will send you an email with a LINK to YOUR specific exam session where you will fill out an exam application (an electronic VEC Form 605). Complete it as soon as it arrives.
- **FCC Registration Number (FRN):** If you do not have an FRN, get an FRN ahead of time by visiting the FCC's [Registration page](#) and clicking "Register for an FRN." This number will be used to uniquely identify you in all transactions with the FCC. You will need your SSN to apply for an FRN. An instructional video, <https://www.fcc.gov/rofrn>, provides step-by-step instructions on how to establish an account.
- **Email Address:** "Applicants are strongly encouraged to provide an email address on their license application(s), which will trigger the electronic issuance of an official copy of their license(s) to the email provided upon application grant." – FCC statement
- **Privacy Information:** Please know that getting a ham radio license will make your name and address public information when the new license is issued. An alternative address, such as a PO Box, would be acceptable. See details here: <http://www.arrl.org/fcc-licensee-privacy>. Social Security numbers, phone numbers, and email addresses are never published.

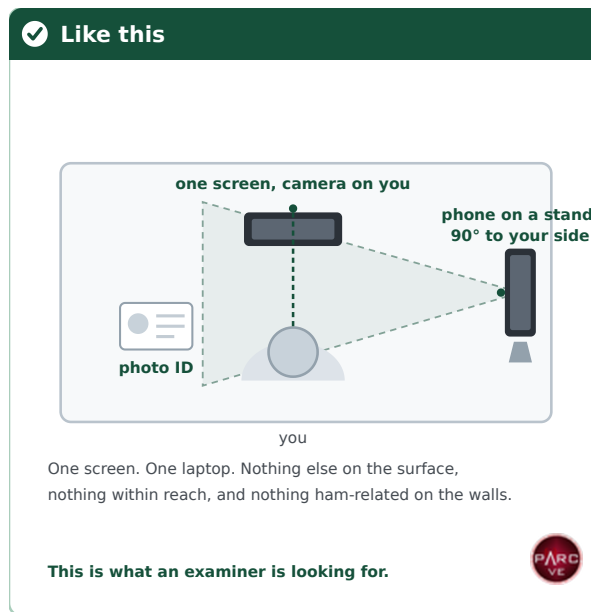
- **Basic Qualification Question:** Applicants are required to answer the FCC basic qualification question (felony question). If an applicant answers YES, they must submit the required documentation directly to the FCC within 14 days as outlined in these instructions: <http://www.arrl.org/fcc-qualification-question>. The candidate should not communicate any information or documents to the Volunteer Examiner team or the VEC.
- **FCC Enforcement Advisory:** “Amateur and Personal Radio Services Licensees and Operators may not use radio equipment to commit or facilitate criminal acts.” “Individuals using radios in the Amateur or Personal Radio Services in this manner may be subject to severe penalties, including significant fines, seizure of the offending equipment, and, in some cases, criminal prosecution.” Download the complete FCC Enforcement Advisory – PUBLIC NOTICE – Federal Communications Commission.

What you need to prepare

- **Exam Application:** FIRST: You “register” for an exam.
- **Exam Fee:** SECOND: The non-refundable \$15 exam fee is paid as part of booking your time slot on the schedule page — there is no separate payment step. PayPal is only used for donations, never for exam fees. The fee is forwarded to the ARRL VEC along with your exam scores and application.
- **U.S. PHOTO ID:** ONE legal PHOTO ID will need to be shown on camera to the VE Team. Adults must show an unexpired state-issued driver’s license, non-driver state ID, or U.S. passport. Under-18 students may show one of the above items, or the student shows one document from our ID list, such as a school ID or birth certificate, while a parent or legal guardian presents their own photo ID. All IDs must be actual physical ID cards. We will not accept digital IDs or other facsimiles of an ID.
- **Parental Consent:** For children age 13 and under, a parent must download and complete this [COPPA Parental Consent Form](#) and email it to the address on the COPPA form. For children under 13, the parent will stay in the room during the child’s exam.

Prepare your exam room

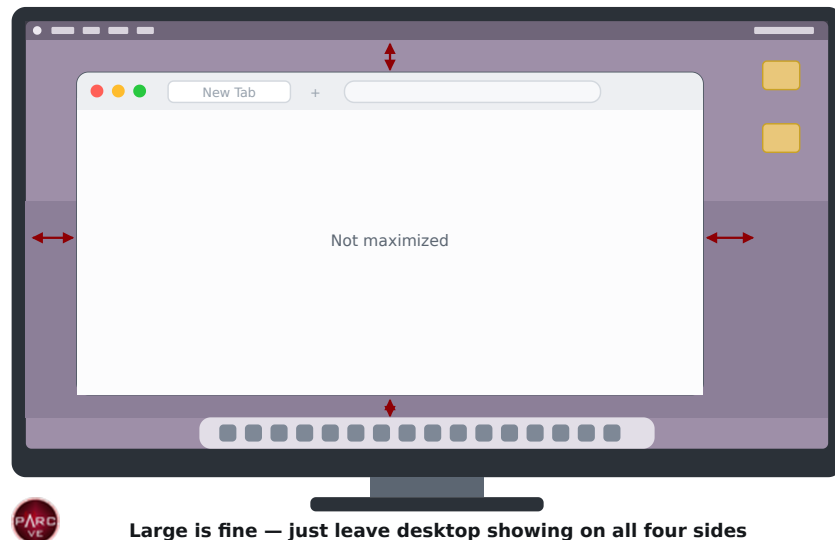
- Clear the Exam Room of any non-exam materials that could aid in taking the exam, such as papers, notes, posters, computer screens, calculators, watches. Many people just use a bathroom to simplify everything. You may not be in a vehicle, outdoors, or in a public space. Private library rooms are OK. TVs must be unplugged or covered with a sheet.
- Sit at a table or flat, sturdy surface so that your computer and smartphone can be solidly arranged without moving or falling over. Do not sit on a bed or a movable chair.
- Clear your exam table of ALL items within reach or view that would raise suspicion, such as papers, sticky notes, electronic items, monitors, headphones, food, drinks, and anything unnecessary for the exam (see picture).
- NO Virtual Backgrounds or Blinds are allowed; we must see the entire room.
- Warn family members not to enter the room during the exam. If someone enters, the exam must be voided.
- No other people or pets allowed in the exam room or vicinity, except a registered service dog.



Clear your exam table of ALL items within reach or view.

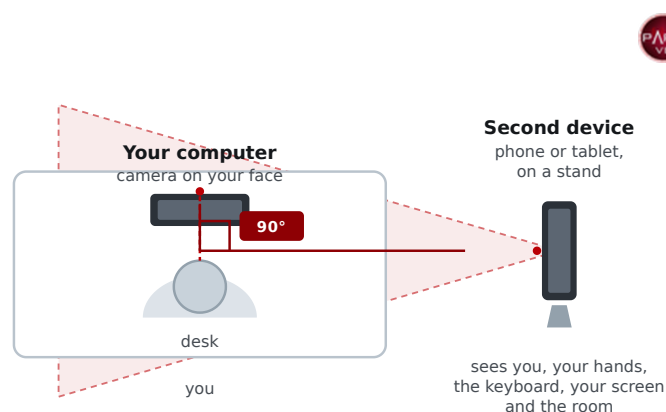
Prepare your computer

- You must have a working Windows 10 or later, or Mac, laptop or desktop computer, with a webcam that looks straight at your face (on a laptop, the built-in one), a microphone, and reliable Internet service (no VPN, no hotspots).
- You may **NOT** use any kind of tablet, iPad, Chromebook, or Linux computer. They won't work.
- Remove ALL audio devices, headphones, earbuds, smartwatches, HATS, Bluetooth mice, secondary monitors or keyboards, and anything that could be considered suspicious and unnecessary for the exam.
- Disable chat, alerts, Bluetooth devices, virtual screens, VPN, pop-up apps.
- NO EXTERNAL MOUSE OR KEYBOARD is allowed to be connected to a laptop. You will press the A, B, C, and D keys to answer a question and automatically advance to the next one. You may also use the RIGHT/LEFT ARROW KEYS on your KEYBOARD to advance or go back through the questions.
- **TEST your browser.** Be sure it is NOT full screen and fits as shown in the picture below, then close it.
- **Use the calculator built into ExamTools.** Do not open a separate calculator app, and do not have a physical calculator in the room.
- Download Zoom on both computer and phone. Use [this link to TEST them](#). Zoom must run as an APPLICATION. It cannot be in a browser.
- At least 45 minutes before your exam we will email you a link to join Zoom on BOTH the computer and phone.
- SIGN OUT of Zoom on both devices before you join. When Zoom asks for your name, type your name followed by computer or phone. You cannot rename a device in the waiting room.
- Practice the SHARE YOUR SCREEN option of Zoom. Practice with a friend.
- Practice minimizing the ZOOM DISPLAY BOXES so they don't block your browser.



Prepare your smartphone

- An Internet-connected cell phone with a built-in camera is required.
- Phone must be charged or plugged in.
- Download Zoom on both computer and phone and use [this link to TEST them](#).
- DO NOT TOUCH YOUR PHONE when the exam team brings it in. WAIT FOR INSTRUCTIONS. We need to CANCEL AUDIO on the cell phone so it won't cause audio feedback.
- “Auto-join Audio” must be OFF. “Do Not Disturb” must be ON.
- Learn how to REVERSE VIDEO from “selfie” view to room view and how to hold the camera in horizontal orientation. You will use the camera to scan the room, the computer, and your hands for security compliance, then use the camera to observe you during the session.
- Prepare a way to PROP UP THE PHONE to see the computer from a SIDE VIEW HORIZONTALLY during the exam.



Directly to your left or right — not behind you.

An examiner must see your hands and your screen at once. Both devices stay on Zoom throughout.

Prop up the phone to view the computer screen and keyboard from the SIDE. Like this!

Exam day procedures

Be ready 45 minutes before exam time

- REVIEW ALL RULES and correctly prepare your exam area, computer, and phone. (Especially about NO WATCHES, NO HATS, DON'T TOUCH YOUR PHONE WHEN IT JOINS, etc.)
- HAVE ID READY TO SHOW. **NO OTHER PAPERS** — no PIN, no FRN. You do not need anything else!
- NAME YOUR COMPUTER and PHONE as you join, signed out of Zoom, so the Exam Manager knows which is which. EXAMPLE: "Jane Doe computer" and "Jane Doe phone"
- ZOOM: Queue up in the ZOOM waiting room BOTH your computer and smartphone, 45 minutes early, using the link we sent you in an email. (Check your spam filter if you don't see the email.)
- QUIT ALL APPLICATIONS except Zoom.
- DO NOT TOUCH YOUR PHONE when we bring it into the session until we CANCEL AUDIO so it won't cause feedback.
- FOLLOW DIRECTIONS and DO NOT INTERRUPT THE EXAMINER! It causes Zoom to mute the speaker, so you will miss instructions.